

My Regulation Toolkit

DURATION	35–40 min · Unit 1 Week 5 (after Lesson 4, before Lesson 5)
OBJECTIVE	Students name their three regulation strategies — one body-based, one cognitive, one relational — and record them on WS-R1 (My Toolkit), which they will carry and reference all year.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: emotional regulation and self-monitoring · Self-Awareness: recognizing internal states
NEW ANCHOR CHART	Window of Tolerance (WOT-1) — introduced in this lesson. Must be posted before class begins.
WORKSHEET	WS-R1: My Regulation Toolkit — completed and owned by student. Not collected.
VOCABULARY	regulation, window of tolerance, activated, settled, strategy, toolkit

PLACEMENT NOTE

This lesson is delivered between Unit 1 Lesson 4 (My Inner Critic vs. My Inner Coach) and Lesson 5 (Guilt vs. Shame). Placement here is intentional: students have now met the inner critic — they know the voice that attacks identity after a mistake. This lesson gives them the physical and practical infrastructure to regulate the activation that the critic produces before it overwhelms them. The guilt/shame distinction in Lesson 5 will be significantly more accessible to students who have this toolkit in hand.

SAFETY NOTE

This is a standard-risk lesson. No counselor co-facilitation is required. However: some students have learned to be disconnected from their body as a protective response to trauma or chronic stress. For these students, body-awareness prompts can feel disorienting or activating. Monitor during the body strategy section. If a student appears distressed during any body-awareness activity, offer the option to observe rather than participate. Note for counselor awareness — this student may benefit from individual support before the deeper emotional content in Units 2 and 3.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Display all Unit 1 anchor charts simultaneously. "In Unit 1 we have been building something together — a more honest map of who we are. We named our strengths. We said emotions are information. We learned about the inner critic and what it does." Pause. "Today is different. Today is not a concept. It is a toolkit. And this toolkit is going to be on your desk in some form for the rest of this year — because everything we do in Units 2 and 3 gets easier when you have it."